How-To Library

Informatica

Enterprise Data Catalog types of metadata

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Abstract

This article describes the types of metadata used in the Enterprise Data Catalog.

In the article, you can find information about the following types of metadata:

- Physical metadata
- Lineage and impact metadata
- Transformation metadata
- Data modeling metadata
- Business intelligence metadata
- Data quality metadata
- Collaboration metadata

Supported Versions

- Enterprise Data Catalog 10.4.1.2

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Physical metadata

Physical metadata is stored on the data model, application, or storage service.

You can distinguish the following examples of physical metadata:

- Names of tables, reports, objects, and columns
- Data types
- Profiling analysis of the data

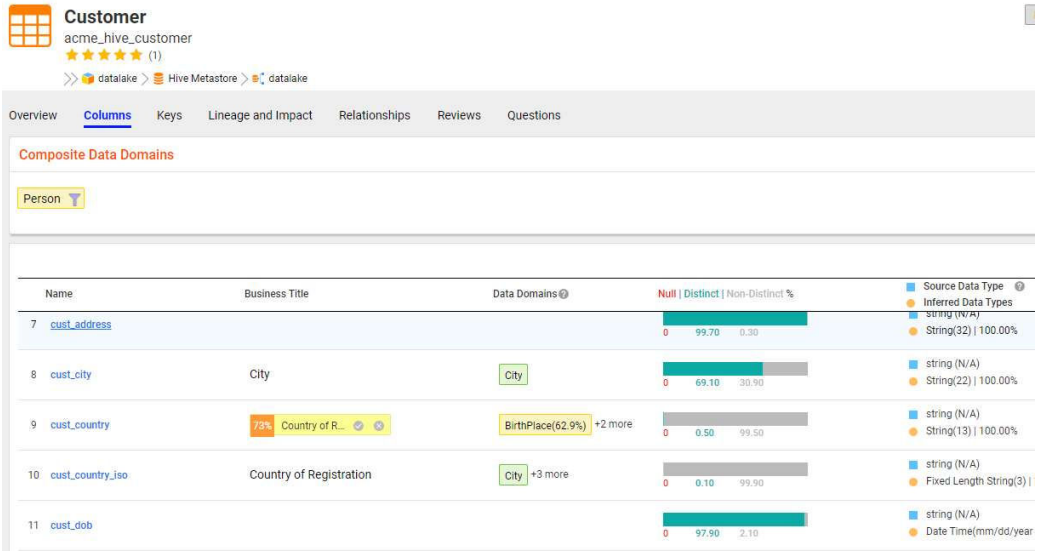
Informatica has automated scanners that connect directly to the data movement tool, an application to collect and store the physical metadata of a specific technology. You can schedule or launch this scan manually to ensure the technical metadata is up to date and represents the implementation in the source system.

The following scanners use physical metadata:

- Relational DB: Oracle, SQL, DB2, Teradata
- Storage: ADLS, Blob, OneDrive
- Big Data: HDFS, Hive
- Applications: Salesforce, Workday

- Cloud Warehouse: Synapse, Snowflake

The following image shows an example of physical metadata:



Lineage and impact metadata

Lineage metadata is a representation of how data moves from one system to another.

See the following examples of lineage and impact metadata:

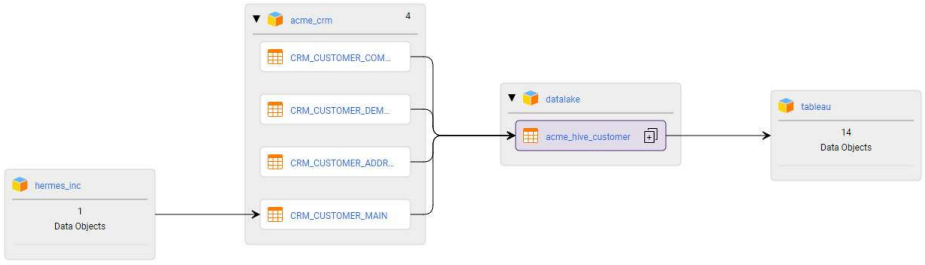
- ETL jobs
- Scripts
- Database definitions at the table, column, and database level

You can ensure that the technical metadata is up to date and represents the implementation in the source system by running a scan with the data movement tool.

The following scanners use linage and impact metadata:

- Relational DB: Oracle, SQL, Hive, Teradata, SAP Hana, DB2
- Storage: ADLS, Blob, OneDrive, GCS
- Big Data: HDFS, Hive
- Applications: Salesforce, Workday
- Reporting: SAP, Tableau, PowerBI
- Cloud Warehouse: Synapse, Snowflake, BigQuery

The following image shows an example of lineage and impact metadata:



Transformation metadata

Transformation metadata is a representation of how data transforms from one system to another.

See the following examples of transformation metadata:

- Transformations
- Functions
- Logic and calculations at the column level

You can ensure that the technical metadata is up to date and represents the implementation in the source system by running a scan with the data movement tool.

The following scanners use transformation metadata:

- Scripts DB: Oracle PL/SQL, Teradata, HiveQL
- BI Applications: Teradata, PowerBI, SAP, Microstrategy, SAP
- Informatica: Powercenter, IICS, IDQ, BDM, MDM, DIH
- Big Data: Navigator, Atlas
- Other ETL: SSIS
- Cloud: AWS Glue

The following image shows an example of transformation metadata:



Data modeling metadata

Data modeling metadata is a representation of how data assets are logically and conceptually designed.

See the following examples of data modeling metadata:

- LogicalModel
- PhysicalModel
- Data Object

- Erwin
- Relationship

Informatica has automated scanners that connect directly to the modeling solution collecting all the metadata that can be represented within the operating system. Users can see what was defined in the model and compare it to the implementation.

The following scanners use data modeling metadata:

- SAP Powerdesigner
- Erwin

Business intelligence metadata

Business metadata is a representation of the semantic representation of a technical data asset.

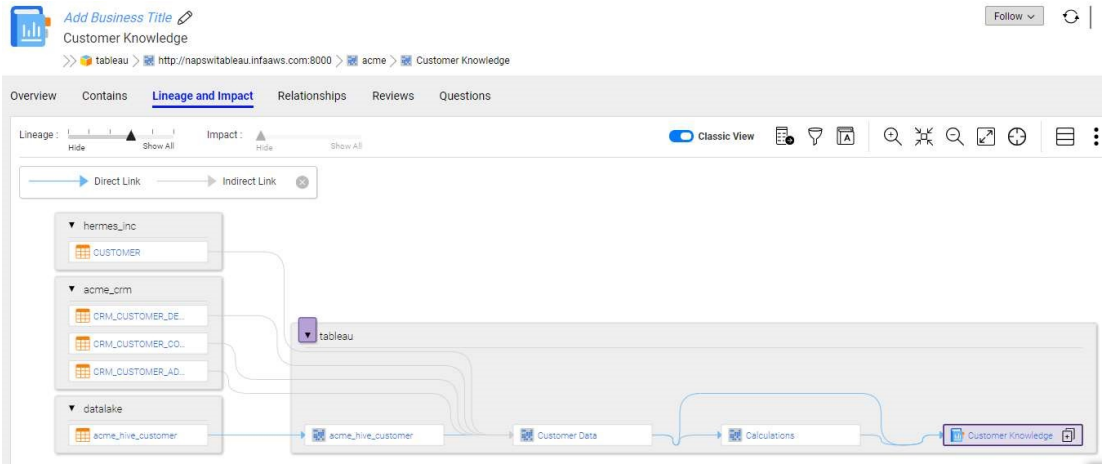
Data owners, stewards, and governance counsels define these terms, domains, and classifications in governance, glossary, or excel locations.

Informatica automatically integrates with its knowledge repository and governance tools that store the business context within your organization. You can import terms from external tools or manual glossaries into Enterprise Data Catalog for association with technical assets.

The following scanners use business intelligence metadata:

- Tableau
- Microstrategy
- PowerBI
- QLIKView
- SAP Business Objects, Warehouse, 4HANA
- IBM Cognos
- OBIEE

The following image shows an example of business intelligence metadata:



Data quality metadata

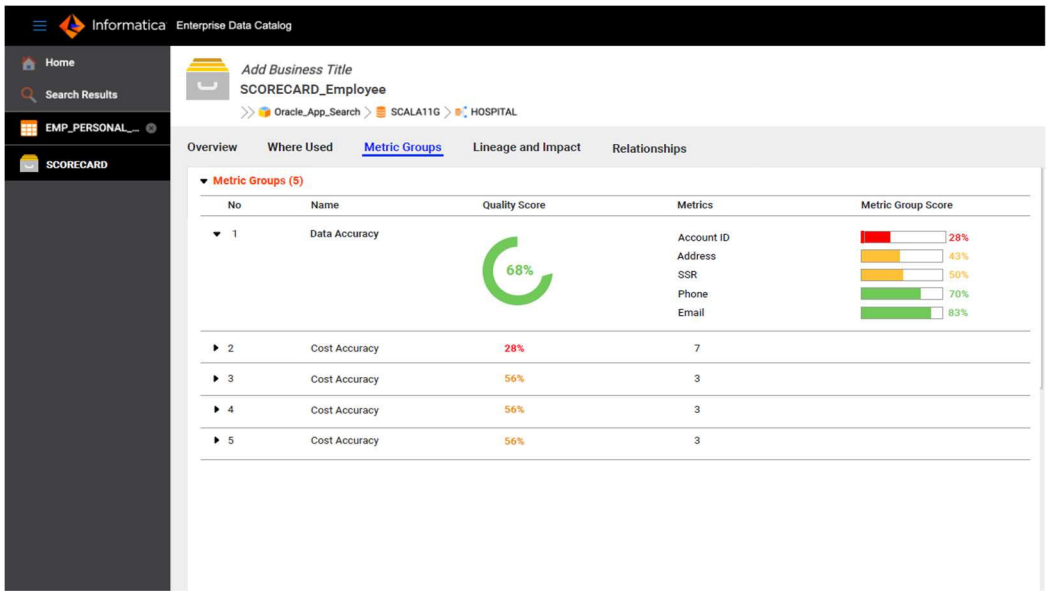
Data quality metadata is a representation of the data quality rule metrics for a specific technical asset.

You can access metric scores, groups, and scores of that asset.

Informatica can scan the profiling warehouse associated with your IDQ deployment. To assess the quality of an asset directly in the catalog view, you can access and display the metrics directly for a user.

Informatica Data Quality is a scanner that uses the data quality metadata.

The following image shows an example of data quality metadata:



Collaboration metadata

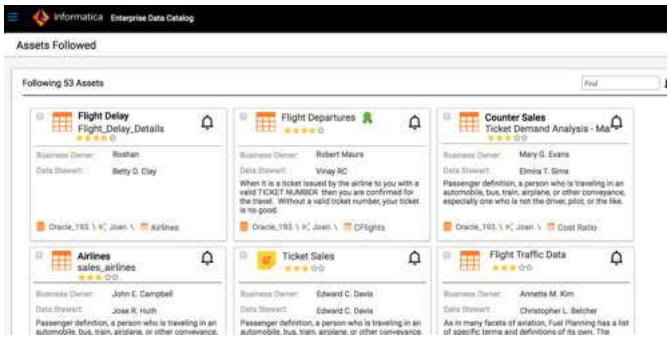
Collaboration metadata is the content that the community of users provides through interaction with the catalog. It is often not formally documented anywhere else.

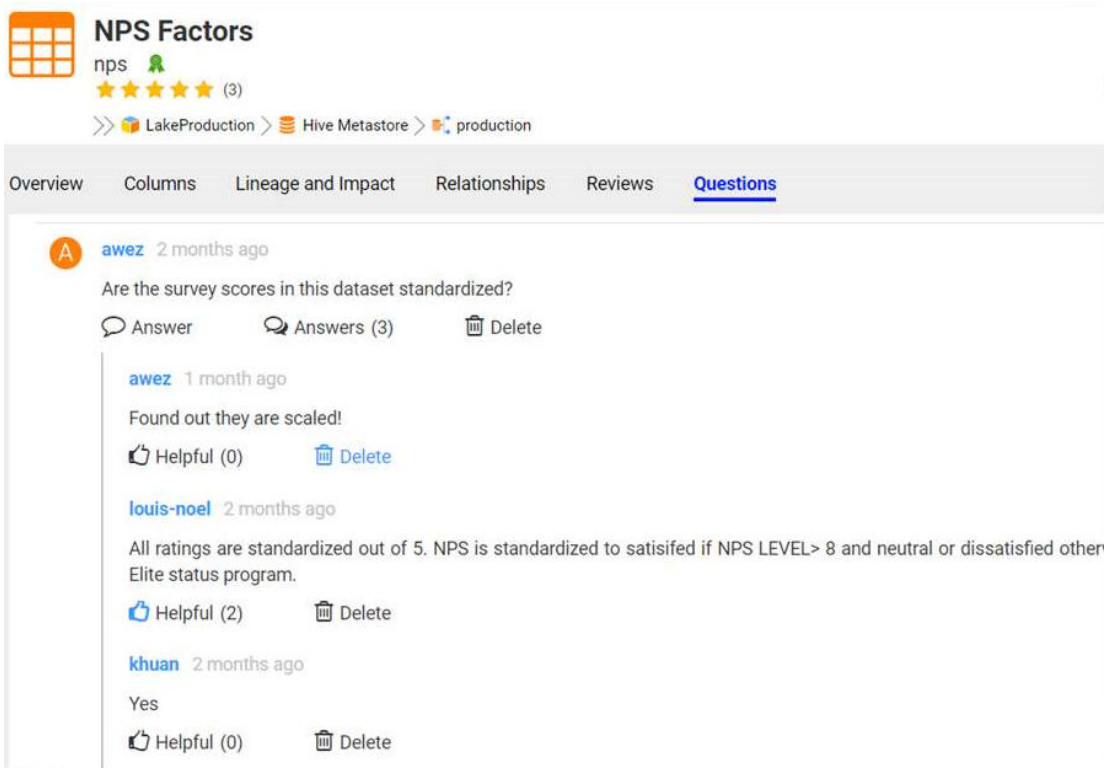
Informatica collects this metadata directly from the community from users within the Enterprise Data Catalog user interface. Users can collaborate and document tribal knowledge for others to reference and respond.

See the following examples of collaboration metadata:

- Comments
- Questions and Answers
- Ratings

The following images show examples of collaboration metadata:





Authors

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